



AFRICAN CONNECTIONS
"Your Gateway to Africa"

Welcomes You to Togo



Woezo (Welcome in Ewe)

Thank you for choosing African Connections to provide comprehensive tour services for your upcoming “Ghana, Togo, Benin Tour” scheduled for January 4th – 16th 2026 (12 nights/13 days).

African Connections, “AC” is your Gateway to Africa. We have been a leader in African travel for over 20 years and the entire AC Team is preparing for your upcoming visit to Togo.

We pride ourselves on delivery of outstanding concierge services and we are happy to assist you and provide you with information you’ll need to prepare for your journey.

When you reach Togo, we will meet you at the airport when you arrive and assist you throughout your stay in Togo.

Our team is knowledgeable and professional and proud to show you the wonders of Togo, a country we know so well.

This welcome guide will provide you with information that will be helpful as you make your travel preparations.

Please review this information carefully. We welcome your questions and look forward to seeing you in Togo soon!

Your Tour

You should book your tickets so that you depart from the USA on January 3rd 2026, with your arrival in Ghana on January 4th 2026.

Your tickets should have you depart from Ghana on January 16th 2026, and arrive back in the United States on January 17th 2026.

Your tour begins when you arrive in Ghana on January 4th 2026 and ends when we see you off at the airport on January 16th 2026.

Togo Travel Requirements

Togo is a tourist friendly destination, but it is important that you are aware of travel requirements and have your travel documents ready well in advance of your departure date. Please read the following information carefully.

Passports and Visas

A valid passport is required for all international travel.

U.S. citizens need a visa to enter Togo for stays of up to 90 days. However, there are other requirements to meet, including:

Passport: A valid U.S. passport with at least one blank visa page

Proof of travel: Proof of return or onward flights

Proof of funds: Proof of sufficient funds for the duration of your stay

Proof of purpose: Documents showing the purpose of your trip

E-Visa Fee: \$ 61.43

Your passport must be valid for at least six months from the date of your arrival back in the United States. Check your passport expiration date to be sure it meets this requirement and if necessary, apply for a renewal as soon as possible. You will not be allowed to board your departure flight if your passport expiration date is within six months of your scheduled return to your home country.

Immunization and Medical Information

Yellow Fever Vaccination:

A current yellow fever vaccination is required if you are arriving from an infected area within 5 days. However, it not required by US Citizens if you have not been in an infected area.

If you get the Yellow Fever vaccine, be sure this is indicated in your yellow International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis (ICVP). **It is your responsibility to comply with all immunization requirements.**

Malaria Prevention and other Immunizations:

Your doctor might also recommend other vaccinations which are not mandatory for travel to Senegal. It is up to you to decide if you take any or all such recommended vaccinations as they are not required for entry into Togo.

While it is not mandatory, we strongly recommend that you acquire anti-malarial medication. Malaria is a serious potential (but treatable) health threat, and you should take necessary precautions to minimize your risk.

It is also a good idea to bring your favorite mosquito repellent to further protect yourself from the mosquitos that you might encounter.

Prescription Medications:

If you take prescription medication, you are responsible for determining their legality in Senegal and note the following:

- We advise you to bring enough of your medication with you.
- Always keep your medication in the original container.
- Carry a copy of your prescription(s).
- Pack your medicine in your carry-on luggage, not your checked luggage.

Travel Insurance

Travel Insurance is not included in your package. However, it is strongly recommended that you purchase travel insurance to cover any unexpected event that might interrupt or prevent your travel.

Our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click on the link below or go to our website www.africanconnections-usa.com to get a quote.

<https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&accam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMNXVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4>

Shopping in Togo

You will love shopping in Togo! Whether you're browsing handcrafted goods in Lomé's lively open-air markets or visiting artisan cooperatives in the lush hill towns of Kpalimé, Togo offers a rich and authentic shopping experience. From beautifully woven kente and batik fabrics to intricate beadwork, wooden masks, traditional drums, and locally made shea butter products, Togo is a

haven for unique, meaningful souvenirs. The vibrant colors, craftsmanship, and cultural depth of Togolese art make every purchase a true keepsake of your journey.

Clothing and Packing

Bring comfortable outfits—lightweight cotton or breathable fabrics will help you stay cool and comfortable in Togo’s warm and often humid climate. A light sweater or jacket is recommended for cooler evenings or early mornings, especially if you’ll be visiting higher elevations like Kpalimé. Be sure to pack comfortable walking shoes or sandals for tours and market visits.

Note: Togo is a culturally diverse country with both traditional and religious influences, including Christianity, Islam, and indigenous faiths. While dress codes are generally relaxed, it's respectful to dress modestly, especially when visiting villages, religious sites, or government buildings. There will be opportunities to swim at the beach or at hotel pools, so don’t forget your swimsuit and a swim cover-up.

Don’t bring electrical appliances and gadgets. The electric outlets in Togo are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. **This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Togo.** The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Togo. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Togo are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

You can bring your own adapter or buy one when you arrive as adapters are very inexpensive in Togo and are readily available.

Toiletries/Personal Items

Be sure you bring all your toiletries and personal items. While you will have opportunities to buy such things in Togo, you might not be able to find the brands you prefer.

Customs Requirements

Passengers’ obligations at **Togo Customs** are outlined on the **Togolese Revenue Office (OTR)** website. For full details on what you can and cannot bring into the country, please visit: <https://www.otr.tg/index.php/en>

When you arrive in Togo you will pass through Togo Customs, and you might be asked if you have anything to declare. You must declare any commercial goods or currency more than \$10,000 that you bring into Togo.

Money/Credit and Debit Cards/ATM's:

Cash

There is no limit on the amount of money you can bring into Togo. However, as stated above, if you bring in more than \$10,000 in cash, you must declare it when you pass through customs on entry. If you bring in less than \$10,000, there is no need to declare any cash that you bring in.

You will have several opportunities to change your dollars for the local currency during your stay in Togo. Please note that it is advisable that you bring any cash that you bring in either \$100 or \$50 bills as smaller denominations will be exchanged for a significantly lower exchange rate.

ATMs

There are ATMs in all the major cities you visit, but you will pay an international fee and a local bank fee for ATM transactions in addition to possibly receiving a lower exchange rate for each transaction.

Credit and Debit Cards

There will be a few places where you can use your credit or debit card, but for the most part, Togo is a cash economy. If you intend to use your debit or credit card, when this option is available, you should inform your bank that you are traveling to Togo to prevent a fraud alert or possible block of your card when you try to use it in Togo.

Also, note, many of the businesses that take debit or credit cards use POS equipment which requires a pin number. While we all know our debit card pin number, most of us do not have or know a pin number for our credit cards. So, if you intend to use a credit card, contact your bank, and make sure you have and know the pin number associated with the card.

Note: the only credit cards accepted in Togo are Visa and Mastercard.

Food and Water

Your tour package includes breakfast daily and other specified meals (lunch/dinner), including a Welcome Dinner with Cultural Performances.

You will be able to buy meals that are not included in the tour package at restaurants that we have carefully selected. There will be many food choices and you will be able to sample delicious

Togolese dishes, but more familiar dishes will also be available to you. The average cost of a meal with a soft drink and water, in Togo ranges from \$15-\$25.

Bottled water is readily available. However, the water in all of the hotels and restaurants that have been selected for you is potable and is safe for you to drink, use as ice cubes or to brush your teeth.

While some of your favorite snacks might be available in Togo, and we will make regular stops for you to stock up on snacks, fruit, and drinks during the trip, it is advisable for you to bring the special snacks that you prefer.

Hotels and Restaurants in Togo:

Hotels

You will be staying at hotels that have been carefully selected for you to ensure your comfort. These hotels are highly rated with clean comfortable rooms and well-trained staff. However, standards might vary from those to which you might be accustomed.

For example, while bath towels and hand towels are available and supplied at all the selected hotels, face cloths are not normally available. So, you should bring your own face cloth.

Rest assured; our ground staff will be available to address any issue that might arise.

Restaurants

We have carefully selected each of the restaurants you will visit on your tour in Togo. These establishments are known for providing clean, wholesome meals in safe and comfortable settings. You'll have the opportunity to enjoy a variety of local Togolese dishes, such as grilled fish with spicy sauces, akume with vegetable stews, and yam-based specialties as well as more familiar continental options.

While the food is freshly prepared and full of flavor, restaurant service in Togo may be slower than what you're used to, as many meals are cooked from scratch. We appreciate your patience and understanding. To help minimize wait times, our staff will assist in placing orders ahead of time whenever possible, so you can enjoy your dining experience without unnecessary delays.

Cell Phone/Data Usage and Internet Service:

Before your departure to Togo contact your mobile phone service provider and request international data service to access WhatsApp, or similar apps for internet-based communications. Such communications are significantly less costly than international roaming charges.

You could also ask for a one-month international voice package. While this could be costly, it is cheaper than the bill you will receive if you make calls without a call package.

If you make or receive international calls while you are in Togo and you do not have the appropriate international call/data packages, you will be shocked when you receive your telephone service billing statement.

Other information that might be helpful as you prepare for your trip:

Country Profile

Togo is located in West Africa, bordered by the Atlantic Ocean (Gulf of Guinea) to the south. It shares land borders with Ghana to the west, Benin to the east, and Burkina Faso to the north. Though small in size, Togo features a rich and varied landscape that includes coastal lagoons, savannas, rolling hills, and lush forests. The country experiences a tropical climate, with distinct wet and dry seasons that vary by region.

The capital city, Lomé, sits along the coast and serves as Togo's economic and cultural hub. Other notable cities include Kpalimé, known for its arts and mountainous scenery; Sokodé, the country's second-largest city; and Kara, a key center in the north. Togo has a population of approximately 8.6 million people, comprising over 40 ethnic groups. The Ewe, Kabye, Tem, and Mina are among the largest. Togo is a religiously diverse country, with Christianity and Islam being the predominant religions, alongside a strong presence of traditional African spiritual practices.

Historically, Togo was home to various indigenous kingdoms and chieftaincies. It later became a German colony in the late 19th century, then passed to French administration after World War I. Togo gained independence from France on April 27, 1960. Since then, the country has experienced a mix of political challenges and democratic reforms, with ongoing efforts to promote stability, development, and national unity.

Geography:

Togo, officially the Togolese Republic, is a narrow country located in West Africa along the Gulf of Guinea on the Atlantic Ocean. Though compact in size, Togo's geography transitions from coastal lowlands in the south to rolling hills, mountainous plateaus, and savannas as you move northward. This diverse terrain supports a variety of ecosystems and agricultural activity.

Togo spans approximately 57,000 square kilometers (about 22,000 square miles) and has a population of around 8.6 million people. The capital, Lomé, is a vibrant coastal city that serves as

the political, cultural, and economic center of the country. Togo's political system is a unitary presidential republic, and while it has faced periods of political tension in the past, the country has made strides toward stability and democratic reform in recent years. Despite its size, Togo plays an important role in regional trade and diplomacy and is known for its cultural richness, religious diversity, and welcoming hospitality.

Economy:

The economy of Togo is diverse and primarily driven by agriculture, phosphate mining, trade, and services. Agriculture employs a large portion of the population, with key crops including cotton, maize, cassava, yams, and coffee. Togo is also one of the world's top producers of phosphate, which is a major export commodity. The country benefits from its strategic location along the Gulf of Guinea, with the Port of Lomé serving as a major gateway for regional trade and transit, especially for landlocked neighboring countries like Burkina Faso and Niger. In addition to trade, services, telecommunications, and small-scale manufacturing are growing contributors to the economy.

Although Togo is rich in natural resources like phosphate and limestone, its long-term development depends on continued investment in infrastructure, education, entrepreneurship, and governance reforms to promote sustainable growth and poverty reduction.

The Currency

The West African CFA Franc is the official currency of Togo. The currency code is XOF, and it is often symbolized as CFA or F CFA. The CFA Franc is shared by several West African countries and is pegged to the Euro, so its exchange rate to the U.S. Dollar may fluctuate slightly over time.

You will be able to exchange U.S. dollars for CFA Francs upon arrival in Togo at the prevailing rate. There is no limit on the amount of cash you may bring into the country, but any amount over \$10,000 USD must be declared upon entry. Amounts below this threshold do not require declaration. Currency exchange services are available at the airport, banks, and authorized currency exchange offices.

Language:

The official language of Togo is French, a legacy of the country's colonial history as part of French West Africa. While French is used in government, education, and formal settings, it is fluently spoken by only a portion of the population, particularly in urban areas.

Togo is linguistically diverse, with over 40 local languages spoken across the country. The most widely spoken indigenous languages are Ewe in the south and Kabiye in the north. Ewe is especially common in cities like Lomé and along the coast, while Kabiye dominates in the Kara and northern regions.

Thanks to this multilingual environment, many Togolese people speak both French and at least one local language, and they are generally welcoming and willing to help visitors communicate. With a few basic French phrases and a friendly attitude, you should have little trouble interacting with locals and enjoying your time in Togo.

Government:

The Constitution of Togo was adopted in 1992, establishing a unitary presidential republic with a government structured around three main branches: the Executive, Legislative, and Judiciary. Togo's political system is guided by principles of separation of powers and rule of law.

The country is divided into five administrative regions: Maritime, Plateaux, Centrale, Kara, and Savanes. These regions are further subdivided into prefectures.

The President, Prime Minister, and members of Parliament are elected by popular vote. Presidential elections are held every five years.

Current President: His Excellency Faure Essozimna Gnassingbé

Current Prime Minister: Victoire Tomegah Dogbé (Togo's first female Prime Minister)

History:

The country now known as Togo has a rich and complex history shaped by ancient cultures, regional kingdoms, and European colonialism. Before European contact, the area was home to various ethnic groups and indigenous kingdoms, including the Ewe and Kabye peoples, who engaged in regional trade, farming, and artisan crafts. In the late 15th century, Portuguese explorers arrived along the coast of West Africa, followed by traders from Germany, Denmark, France, and Britain. These European powers were drawn by Togo's strategic coastal location and became involved in the transatlantic slave trade and later, in palm oil and other goods.

In 1884, Germany declared Togo a protectorate, making it one of its few African colonies. After Germany's defeat in World War I, Togo was divided between France and Britain, with the larger portion becoming French Togoland. Under French rule, Togo remained a mandated territory until it gained independence on April 27, 1960, becoming the Togolese Republic.

Since independence, Togo has experienced political shifts, military rule, and democratic reforms, and continues to build a strong national identity rooted in its diverse culture and resilient people.

Climate:

Togo has a tropical climate characterized by two main seasons: a wet (rainy) season and a dry season. The country's narrow shape and varied elevation contribute to noticeable climate differences from the humid southern coast to the drier northern savannas. Along the southern coastal region, including Lomé, the weather is generally warm and humid, while the central highlands around Kpalimé are slightly cooler due to elevation and lush vegetation. In the north, around Kara and Dapaong, conditions are hotter and drier, with more extreme temperatures during the dry months.

January in Togo falls firmly within the dry season, dominated by the Harmattan winds blowing from the Sahara. Along the southern coast, including Lomé, the weather is warm and relatively dry, with daytime temperatures ranging from 77°F to 88°F (25°C to 31°C). Humidity is lower than during the rainy months, and rainfall is rare, though a light haze from the Harmattan may sometimes reduce visibility. The ocean breeze helps to keep conditions comfortable, making mornings and evenings especially pleasant for outdoor activities. In the central region, such as Kpalimé, January brings cooler and more temperate conditions due to the higher elevation. Daytime temperatures typically range from 73°F to 84°F (23°C to 29°C), with fresh mornings and evenings ideal for hiking in the surrounding hills and forests. Northern Togo, including Kara and Dapaong, is the driest at this time of year, with daytime temperatures often between 86°F and 95°F (30°C to 35°C). Nights, however, can feel surprisingly cool, dropping to around 59°F (15°C). The Harmattan winds are more noticeable in this region, bringing dry, dusty air and occasional haze but also lowering humidity.

Overall, January is one of the best months to visit Togo, with plenty of sunshine, dry weather, and more comfortable conditions for travel across the country. The season makes road travel easier, wildlife viewing more rewarding, and cultural exploration lively, as many communities host traditional events and festivals during this dry and festive time of year.

Frequently Asked Questions

General Travel Information

1. Do I need a visa to visit Togo?

U.S. citizens need visa to visit Togo for up to 90 days. Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your departure date and have at least one blank page for entry stamps.

2. How can I apply for a visa?

You can apply for a visa online via the Togo e-Visa Portal or upon arrival at Togo Airport with entry visas cost of \$61.43. Check our website for the latest visa information and application links.

3. What vaccinations do I need before traveling?

A Yellow Fever vaccination is required for entry into Togo. Other recommended vaccines include Hepatitis A & B, typhoid, tetanus, and malaria prophylaxis.

4. Is Togo safe for tourists?

Togo is one of the safest countries in West Africa. However, tourists should remain cautious in crowded areas, avoid carrying large sums of cash, and use registered taxis or ride-hailing services.

5. What is the best time to visit Togo?

January is one of the best months to visit Togo, with plenty of sunshine, dry weather, and more comfortable conditions for travel across the country. The season makes road travel easier, wildlife viewing more rewarding, and cultural exploration lively, as many communities host traditional events and festivals during this dry and festive time of year.

6. What is the dress code in Togo?

Bring comfortable outfits—lightweight cotton or breathable fabrics will help you stay cool and comfortable in Togo’s warm and often humid climate. A light sweater or jacket is recommended for cooler evenings or early mornings, especially if you’ll be visiting higher elevations like Kpalimé. Be sure to pack comfortable walking shoes or sandals for tours and market visits.

Togo is a culturally diverse country with both traditional and religious influences, including Christianity, Islam, and indigenous faiths. While dress codes are generally relaxed, it's

respectful to dress modestly, especially when visiting villages, religious sites, or government buildings. There will be opportunities to swim at the beach or at hotel pools, so don't forget your swimsuit and a swim cover-up.

7. Are public toilets available at tourist sites?

Public toilets are available at major tourist attractions, but they may not always be well-maintained. Carry tissues and hand sanitizer.

8. Is there internet access?

Hotels, cafes, and restaurants in major cities offer Wi-Fi. A local SIM card is recommended for better mobile internet access.

9. Is it allowed to take photographs of people?

Always ask for permission before photographing individuals, especially in rural areas and markets.

10. What fitness level is required for sightseeing?

A moderate fitness level is recommended, especially for excursions to natural sites and islands.

11. What kind of shoes should I wear?

Comfortable walking shoes are recommended, especially for exploring cities and nature reserves.

12. How is the power supply in Togo?

The electric outlets in Togo are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Togo. The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Togo. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Togo are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

13. Can I drink alcohol in Togo?

Yes, alcohol is available in hotels, restaurants, and bars throughout Togo, especially in urban areas like Lomé, Kpalimé, and Kara. Togo is a religiously diverse country with a mix of Christian, Muslim, and traditional faiths, so while alcohol is generally accessible, availability may be more limited in rural or predominantly Muslim communities.

Popular local beverages include Tchoukoutou (a traditional millet beer), as well as a variety of imported and regional beers, wines, and spirits. Visitors should feel comfortable ordering alcoholic drinks in most tourist-friendly areas, but it's always respectful to be mindful of local customs and religious sensitivities, especially during religious holidays or in conservative regions.

14. Is smoking allowed in Togo?

Smoking is allowed in outdoor areas in Togo; however, it is restricted in enclosed public spaces, such as restaurants, hotels, government buildings, and public transportation. Most indoor public areas have designated non-smoking policies in place to protect public health. Travelers who smoke are advised to do so only in designated smoking areas or in open-air settings, and to be mindful of local customs and other guests, especially in shared spaces like hotel courtyards, balconies, or outdoor dining areas.

15. What food options are available in Togo?

In the hotels we have a full buffet breakfast each day. You will have the opportunity to enjoy a variety of local Togolese dishes, such as grilled fish with spicy sauces, akume with vegetable stews, and yam-based specialties as well as more familiar continental options.

Money & Costs

16. What currency is used in Togo?

The West African CFA Franc (XOF) is the official currency. Credit and debit cards are accepted in major hotels and restaurants, but cash is preferred in markets and rural areas.

17. How much does a meal cost in Togo?

A meal at a mid-range restaurant costs about \$15-\$25, while street food or casual dining can be around \$5-\$10.

18. Can I use U.S. dollars in Togo?

U.S. dollars are not widely accepted. It is best to exchange money at banks or Forex Bureaus.

Transportation & Getting Around

19. Do I need an international driver's license to rent a car?

Yes, an International Driving Permit (IDP) is required to rent a car. Traffic conditions can be hectic, so hiring a driver is recommended.

20. Is public transportation safe?

Public transportation, such as minibuses and shared taxis, can be crowded and confusing. Tourists are advised to use private taxis or ride-hailing services.

Health & Safety

21. Is tap water safe to drink?

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels and the restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

22. Do I need travel insurance?

Yes, travel insurance is highly recommended for medical emergencies, lost luggage, and trip cancellations.

However, our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMN XVK 3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

23. Should I bring my own medicine?

Bring sufficient prescribed medication for your trip. Pharmacies are available, but specific medicines may not always be in stock.

Activities

24. Is there time for shopping?

Yes! You will love shopping in Togo! Whether you're browsing handcrafted goods in Lomé's lively open-air markets or visiting artisan cooperatives in the lush hill towns of Kpalimé, Togo offers a rich and authentic shopping experience. From beautifully woven kente and batik fabrics to intricate beadwork, wooden masks, traditional drums, and locally made shea butter products, Togo is a haven for unique, meaningful souvenirs. The vibrant colors, craftsmanship, and cultural depth of Togolese art make every purchase a true keepsake of your journey.

25. Can I make personal purchases?

Yes, budget around \$8-\$25 per day for personal expenses like snacks, drinks, and souvenirs. Larger purchases can be made with credit cards in major stores.

Prepare to be Amazed!

Beneath the vibrant rhythms and coastal charm of modern Togo lies a land where tradition and progress meet — where sacred forests, bustling markets, colonial echoes, and indigenous heritage create a truly captivating experience. Togo is rich in spirit, culture, and discovery. Have your cameras ready!

The African Connections Team is eagerly awaiting your arrival in Togo and is ready to support you as you prepare for an unforgettable West African adventure!